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ADDRESS BY
THE HONORABLE JOHN FOSTER DULLES
SECRETARY OF STATE
BEFORE THE FOREIGN POLICY ASSOCIATION
WALDORF-ASTORIA HOTEL
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OUR FOREIGN POLICIES IN ASIA

I am glad to be again with the Foreign Policy Association. I first spoke before you 35 years ago. So this is, in a sense, an anniversary. I know well of your work. It is good work and I am glad that it is going on, bringing to our citizenry a better knowledge of our foreign policy.

I

The broad goal of our foreign policy is to enable the people of the United States to enjoy, in peace, the blessings of liberty. Under present world conditions we cannot achieve that goal by thinking of ourselves alone. We must help other peoples to be free. Thus, enlightened self-interest combines with high principle to lead us to do for others what, if conditions were reversed, we would want them to do for us.

Our task is not an easy one, nor one that can be discharged without sacrifice and risk. Stormy winds blow from Moscow and Peiping.

In Moscow, Foreign Minister Molotov pours 17,000 words of abuse upon the Western Powers. In Peiping, Foreign Minister Chou bitterly attacks the United States and threatens to use all the force at his command to capture Formosa.

A heavy responsibility devolves upon the President daily, and upon the Congress, in making delicate decisions which may spell the difference between peace and war.

All of us would like to see peace permanently assured. We long for some simple and certain formula which would relieve

us of the present anxious tasks. But perhaps we are learning a needed lesson, that there is no easy way to win peace.

Twice in our generation efforts have been made to secure peace by broad agreements to abolish war. The Pact of Paris of 1928 binds over sixty nations to renounce war as an instrument of international policy. But shortly after it was made, the nations fought in Europe, Asia and Africa.

The United Nations Charter of 1945 binds sixty nations to refrain in their international relations from the threat or use of force. But there has been armed aggression in Korea which was promoted by Soviet Russia, and later Communist China was found guilty of armed aggression there.

It is good that mankind should by great pronouncements demonstrate its hatred of war and its determination to outlaw war. Idealism is indispensable. But it would be dangerous to assume that treaties or pledges alone would relieve us of the burdensome tasks we undertake in the struggle for peace.

Treaty pledges, no matter how solemn, will never restrain powerful and ambitious rulers who do not accept the restraints of moral law and who are not responsive to the will of the people. As against such despots there must be other and further restraints.

Thus the struggle goes on. We dare not relax, because the moment of relaxation is the moment of peril. Treaty declarations must be backed by a purpose that is ever sustained, by an intelligence that is ever alert, and by power which is ever ready and able to punish aggressors so that aggression will not pay.

Whenever the advocates of peace seem to lack these qualities, then peace is in jeopardy. On the other hand, so long as those qualities are manifestly present, then we can have good hope that the battle for peace will be won.

That hope is the more justified because modern weapons possess such immense destructive power. That fact is frightening. But the very fact that it is frightening means that even the most reckless will pause before taking action which would bring modern weapons into play.

During these days the Soviet and Chinese Communists are probing deeply the intentions of the free nations. But we need not feel worried or despondent for what the despots will discover from their probing ought to restrain them.

In Europe there seems no retreat from the basic resolve to create the Western European Union and so to end the disunity of Western Europe. To replace that disunity and weakness with unity and strength will be the greatest single contribution which could be made to the cause of peace.

In Western Europe there are over 200,000,000 highly civilized people. They possess in the aggregate the intellectual and material resources to be both prosperous and safe -- provided only that they are united in spirit and properly organized to work together. When this unity is

achieved, great things will come about. Western Europe will not only have the strength to solve its own internal and external problems but will be a mighty force to preserve world peace.

II

In the Far East the United States has responded to the desire of others that we join with them to assure their security. During the last four years, the United States has become party to security treaties with Korea, Japan, the Republic of China on Formosa, the Philippines, Australia and New Zealand. Also we have joined the eight-power Manila Pact for the security of Southeast Asia.

The total of these Treaties is a mutual security system which, starting from the Aleutian Islands in the North, runs in a great arc to the South Pacific. This constitutes a defensive bulwark for freedom in that part of the world.

What has thus been done by many nations is important. Also important is the manner in which the United States has played its part, particularly during recent days.

When the Congress convened last January, it was organized by the Democratic Party. So when the Manila Pact and the China Treaty were submitted, they were submitted by a Republican President to a Democrat-controlled body. The same was true of President Eisenhower's request for Congressional authority to use the armed forces of the United States in the Formosa area.

Nevertheless, the two Treaties were ratified and the Congressional authority was granted. This was done promptly and with virtual unanimity.

These events demonstrate a national unity and capacity for action which is needed in the world today. Too often representative processes lead to such partisanship and such consequent delays that hostile forces are encouraged to believe that democracies are inherently ineffective. The Government of the United States has shown the contrary. Partisanship was wholly subordinated to the national good, so that action of great importance could be taken with deliberation, but with decisiveness.

For this the nation can be grateful to the leadership and to the general membership of both parties in the Congress. I know that they would expect me to pay special tribute to Walter F. George, who, as Chairman of the Senate Foreign Relations Committee, carried the heaviest aggregate burden of responsibility in relation to the three acts to which I refer.

We can all take pride, as Americans, in this demonstration of national unity and capacity. Because of it, free men throughout the world can face the future with better hope and new confidence.

III

While the capacity of the representative form of government has been recently demonstrated in the United States, there has been occurring in Moscow an extraordinary demonstration of despotic disarray. The Prime Minister of the Soviet State was peremptorily summoned to a high Soviet session in the Kremlin and subjected to the public humiliation of hearing another read his resignation and his confession of "my guilt".

With that Communist verdict we need not quarrel. But the full significance of what has occurred is still obscure and perhaps the last act of the drama has not yet been played.

Undoubtedly, we see an elemental, personal struggle for power. But also one can perceive the outlines of a basic policy difference. There must be those who are primarily concerned with the welfare, security and greatness of the Soviet Union and its people. There are others who would have the Soviet Union and its power serve primarily as a tool of International Communism and as a means of achieving its worldwide ambitions. These two ends, the one symbolized by the State, the other by the Party, do not always coincide.

To us, the Party and the State in Russia usually seem indistinguishable, because many individuals serve in dual capacities. But Lenin and Stalin constantly emphasized the distinction between the two. "The Party", said Stalin, "is not and cannot be identified with the State power."

We should keep that distinction in mind. The time may come -- I believe it will come -- when Russians of stature will patriotically put first their national security and the welfare of their people. They will be unwilling to have that security and that welfare subordinated to the worldwide ambitions of International Communism. If their point of view should prevail, then indeed there could be a basis for worthwhile negotiation and practical agreements between the United States and the new Russia. Then there might be reactivated the historic friendship between our countries and our peoples.

IV

Let me turn now to deal with some of the substantive problems which arise out of the two Far Eastern Treaties to which I have referred -- the China Treaty and the Manila Pact.

The United States is firmly committed to the defense of Formosa and the Pescadores. These islands became part of the Japanese Empire in 1895. They continued as such for half a century, until they were relinquished by Japan as a result of her defeat in war -- a defeat principally wrought by the efforts and sacrifices of the United States.

These islands form an important part of the Western Pacific defense system which I have described. The people of the islands eagerly seek our help.

Thus Formosa and the Pescadores have been properly a matter of concern to the United States.

In 1945 our long-time ally, the Republic of China, was entrusted with authority over these islands. In 1950, when the aggression against Korea occurred, President Truman ordered our Pacific fleet to defend Formosa against possible Chinese Communist attack. Now, that determination has been converted into our Mutual Defense Treaty with the Republic of China.

It is important to note that the Treaty, except as it relates to United States territories, covers only the islands of Formosa and the Pescadores, and an armed attack directed against those islands. The Congressional authority is to secure and protect Formosa and the Pescadores against armed attack, and to make secure and to protect "related positions and territories" as the President judges "this would be required or appropriate in assuring the defense of Formosa and the Pescadores".

The President did not use our Armed Forces to help the Chinese Nationalists to hold the Tachen Islands and Yushan and Pishan, lying some 200 miles north of Formosa. These islands were virtually unrelated to the defense of Formosa and the Pescadores. We helped the Chinese Nationalists to evacuate these islands and regroup their forces, so as to avoid a bloody and wasteful battle which would have inflamed public emotions. Thus, Nationalist China and the United States have made an important contribution to the cause of peace.

It has been suggested that Nationalist China should go further and surrender to the Chinese Communists the coastal positions which the Communists need to stage their announced attack on Formosa.

It is doubtful that this would serve either the cause of peace or the cause of freedom.

The Chinese Communists have been the initiators of violence in this area. They have already formally declared their intention to take Formosa by force. If the Chinese Nationalists now oblige by making it easier for the Chinese Communists to conquer Formosa, will they be less apt to do so? I doubt it.

The United States has no commitment and no purpose to defend the coastal positions as such. The basic purpose is to assure that Formosa and the Pescadores will not be forcibly taken over by the Chinese Communists. However, Foreign Minister Chou says they will use all their force to take Formosa and they treat the coastal islands as means to that end. When the Nationalists voluntarily evacuated the Tachen islands, the Chinese Communists' comment was: "the liberation of these islands has created favorable conditions for our People's Liberation Army in the liberation of Formosa".

Thus the Chinese Communists have linked the coastal positions to the defense of Formosa. That is the fact which, as President Eisenhower said in his message to Congress about Formosa, "compels us to take into account closely related localities". Accordingly, we shall be alert to subsequent Chinese Communist actions, rejecting for ourselves any initiative of warlike deeds.

It is hardly to be expected that the Chinese Communists will renounce their ambitions. However, might they not renounce their efforts to realize their goals by force?

Such renunciation of force is one of the basic principles of the United Nations, and the United States had hoped, and

still hopes, that the United Nations may be able to effect a cessation of the present hostilities. President Eisenhower, in his message to Congress dealing with this matter, made clear that the United States would welcome action by the United Nations which might bring an end to the active hostilities in the area. The Government of New Zealand has brought this situation before the Security Council, and the United States, in the interest of peace, went to the length of voting to invite the Chinese Communists to come to the Security Council to discuss the matter.

In 1950, the Chinese Communists had accepted a Security Council invitation in relation to Korea. However, this time the Chinese Communists contemptuously rejected the invitation.

We sincerely hope that this decision of the Chinese Communists is not irrevocable and that they will abide by the principles of the United Nations rather than challenge by force the defensive obligations of this country. In any event, we believe that their attitude toward the United Nations Security Council has not ended the responsibility of that body which, by the Charter, has the "primary responsibility for the maintenance of international peace and security".

It should not, moreover, be carelessly assumed that peace and security will be promoted merely by the non-Communist nations indefinitely granting one-sided concessions to the Communist nations.

A great danger in Asia is the fear of many non-Communist peoples that the United States has no real intention of standing firmly behind them. Already that fear has mounted to the danger point. We accepted in Korea an armistice which the Chinese Communists boisterously misrepresent as a "victory" for them. We acquiesced in an Indochina armistice which reflected the defeat of the French Union forces at Dien Bien Phu. We aided the Tachen evacuation. The reasons were compelling, nevertheless the result added a few square miles to the Communist domain.

If the non-Communist Asians ever come to feel that their Western Allies are disposed to retreat whenever Communism threatens the peace, then the entire area could quickly become indefensible.

As the situation now exists, neither the cause of freedom, nor United States security, nor world peace and security, would be promoted by undermining the faith of the free Asian peoples in our strength and in our willingness to use that strength to restrain those who violently menace liberty. The American people have, through the Congress, made their own resolution clear. That is a verdict which the Government accepts as sound and which it will soberly execute.

V

Let me turn now to Southeast Asia. In a few hours I shall be going to Bangkok to attend the first meeting of the

Council created under the Manila Pact for the security of Southeast Asia.

We shall at Bangkok deal with the problem of organizing the Treaty Council. Also we shall begin to deal with the three substantive problems assigned to the Council, namely military security, security against subversion directed from without, and economic welfare. I cannot anticipate what the decisions will be, but I am confident that our gathering will show the advantages of cooperation between the East and the West.

Some Asians retain a fear, derived from past colonial relationships, that close ties with the Western powers will lead to their being dominated by the Western powers. It is essential that that fear should be dispelled.

An important step in that direction was taken at Manila when, at the inspiration of President Magsaysay, the eight powers there signed the Pacific Charter. Thereby we dedicated ourselves to promoting self-government and to securing independence for all countries whose peoples desire it and are able to undertake its responsibilities. Also, we agreed to cooperate in the economic, social and cultural fields in order to promote higher living standards, economic progress and social well-being.

However, words are not enough. It is necessary to infuse these words with the breath of life. That, I hope, will be done at Bangkok. Those who gather there will meet as equals. We shall, I think, find ways to diminish the risk of armed attack against the Treaty area and the danger of subversion from without. Also we shall begin to study economic problems. These are not capable of any dramatic and spectacular solution, but they do respond to steady, painstaking and sympathetic efforts.

The first task is to deal with fundamentals. That we are already doing, particularly in the basic realm of education. United States universities and colleges are cooperating with Asian institutions in Thailand, the Philippines, and Pakistan. Many United States technicians are serving in Asia in economic, educational and health tasks, and the number is being increased. Our cooperation is already beginning to show results in better food and better health, and we are together taking the first steps to expand trade, to increase private investment and to raise standards of living.

In such ways, we can justify man's faith in freedom.

There should indeed be no cleavage between the Western and Asian nations. Our concept of the nature of man had its beginning in Asia, where East and West met. We believe that all men are the creation and concern of a universal God and that He has endowed every person with a right to develop in accordance with the dictates of his individual reason and conscience.

That religious faith, politically translated into the Magna Charta, the French Declaration of the Rights of Man, and our own Declaration of Independence, was, as Lincoln said of our Declaration, nothing exclusive but designed to pro-

vide "liberty, not alone to the people of this country, but hope for the world for all future time".

We also realize that, if human liberty is to be a reality, there must be an economic as well as a political foundation. The impoverished and the destitute cannot be truly free. So we recognize that economic values are essential to give reality to the moral and political values that we cherish.

Such a philosophy is indeed very different from that of Soviet Communism.

Soviet Communism denies the principle of human equality and instead substitutes the principle of class rule.

It denies that men are capable of self-government and substitutes the principle of dictatorship, the so-called dictatorship of the proletariat.

It denies nationalism, except as it can be used as a slogan to drive a wedge between East and West and prepare the way for an absorption of the peoples by International Communism.

It preaches a new doctrine of segregation. The peoples of Asia, it is said, must be segregated from the peoples of the West. The new nations of Asia must be segregated from association with others.

The guile behind this is obvious. The Soviet and Chinese Communists know that their combined power can dominate the Eurasian continent. If the other nations of Europe and Asia stand alone, they will be unable to resist the iron embrace of International Communism.

At the Berlin Conference last year, Mr. Molotov denounced NATO and proposed a European security system which would exclude the United States. Now, the Soviet and Chinese Communists denounce the Manila Pact, because it may bring to Southeast Asia the strength needed to resist Communist aggression.

The Bangkok Conference will enable the free nations of the West and of the East to begin a vital demonstration. They can show that, through association as sovereign equals, they can each help the other to independence, security and wellbeing.

That result accords with the high ideals with which our nation was founded. It is in keeping with what our people have sought throughout their history. So our Delegation goes to Bangkok with confidence, because we know that our mission is sustained by national faith and national purpose.

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State--FD, Wash., D.C.